

The Right Ingredients

You can enhance your site with interactive features. Links such as 'Contact Us', 'About Us', 'Disclaimer', etc, give the user a general idea of your Web site and can induce him to either surf through it or out of it.

The 'Contact Us' link should include your official e-mail addresses where the user can post his queries and complaints, and offer feedback on your content, products or services. Never display your postal address on your site—it can be misused.

The 'About Us' link should offer company details and a brief description of what your Web site offers.

The 'Disclaimer' notice is a legal document that limits your responsibility for the content, products or services offered through the site.

Submitta, which allows you to save time by submitting your site to a number of different search engines.

Other ways of increasing traffic to your Web site could include a co-branding arrangement with other popular sites, advertising in popular chat rooms that will provide links to your site, or just simply e-mailing your Net buddies to check out your site. You can also use services such as SmartClicks (www.smartage.com) that allow you to exchange banners with other members of a huge network.

What else can I add to the site?

Other than the basic Web pages that make up your site, there are several other elements that you can include to make it more interesting. Add a free search engine (using metatags) or maybe a chat room or message board (look at the ones offered by www.beseen.com) that provides people a forum to interact. Another important feature that you would want to add is a Web counter that would help you track the popularity of your Web site. Most of the Web hosting services offer basic counters and search features as free features.

Keeping it ship-shape

Just remember that Web site maintenance is a very essential chore. After all, you don't let your brick-and-mortar home run to seed. Your cyber abode will require some looking-after as well. Be prompt when it comes to maintaining your Web site.

The more complex your site gets, the more difficult it will be to maintain it. You need to be diligent and resourceful to tackle those frustrating times when your ISP fails you, when you have problems using your FTP client, or (God forbid!) the server crashes. Updating your site on a regular basis and maintaining consistency in your content are the surest ways to attract visitors and keep them hooked to your site.

Put out the welcome mat

Well, as you can see, making Web sites is not really a big deal. As long as you are clear about certain key issues such as whether to go in for a free domain or buy it from free domain name providers; the kind of facilities you want your site to have; how you want to promote your site to increase traffic, etc.

So get a head start with this new exciting venture. And get ready for the *muhurat* of your very own cyber home. 🎉

Have insights to share on creating your own Web site?

Write all about it to readersletters@jasubhai.com

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